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Culture (OWC): [Mbuti \(FO04\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Central Africa

Field Date: 1951, 1954-1955

Coverage Date: Not Specified

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Section Title(S)

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Local villagers, who claim also to have the *molimo*, are critical of the occasional joking attitude of the Mbuti and say that they, the villagers, call it out only when someone important has died.

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POLITICAL LIFE

Authority

Putnam goes further than Schebesta with regard to the existence or non-existence of chief-tainship among the Mbuti. Primarily of the net hunters he writes, "...there are no chiefs, councils, or any other formal governing bodies in a pygmy camp" (Putnam, 1948, 334). There is respect, he says, for age and experience (*not* for "elders"); the opinions of the old and the wise are generally heeded. Any individual who shows disrespect for an old man, or who refuses to comply with any reasonable request, is abused by the others. Old men who are eccentrics are ignored.

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